



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Paideia Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.paideiachristian.com/about>

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Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Paideia Christian Academy Nm 88210 presents a clearly Christian, classical schooling identity, emphasizing a classically inflected curriculum and a mission oriented toward character formation in a Christian frame. Public materials from the school highlight a private, classical approach with curriculum focus areas including language, mathematics, rhetoric, history, art, and literature, and they underscore formation of students who love the Lord and who are equipped to engage culture with Scripture's truth. This strongly supports a Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose/Goal orientation that aligns with classical aims, while explicit Great Books, Great Conversation, and Socratic pedagogy are not clearly evidenced in the public site materials. The public content demonstrates a coherent classical self-identification and a theology-inflected educational philosophy, but it does not publicly document several hallmark elements often associated with a full classical curriculum (e.g., explicit Great Books reading, Socratic seminars, or a clearly articulated, grade-9–12–level Socratic pedagogy).

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Key observations driving this assessment: - Strong signaling of classical and Christian foundations (explicitly framed as a private, classical, Christian school; mission and statement of faith referenced; curriculum mentions classical strands such as language, mathematics, rhetoric, history, art, literature). This supports CLASSICAL in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose/Goal. - Curriculum mentions classical subjects but does not publicly confirm Great Books/Great Conversation or a complete Trivium/Quadrivium structure, which reduces Element 3 (Curriculum) to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Pedagogy is not clearly documented as Socratic, Scholé, or other specifically classical methods in the public materials, which leans toward NOT CLASSICAL for Element 4 (Pedagogy) and Element 5 (Faculty) given the lack of explicit faculty portrayal. Element 6 (Parents & Community) shows partnership with parents, aligning with classical practice.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials identify the school as a private, classical, Christian school anchored in a Christian worldview and theology, with a stated Statement of Faith and mission linked on the About page. This demonstrates theological grounding and transcendental aims characteristic of classical education within a Christian frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (from the school materials): Christian, worldview, Scripture, theology, private, classical, curriculum, language, mathematics, rhetoric, history, art, literature. These terms align with Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (e.g., theology, sacred scripture, liturgy, truth, virtue, classical tradition). See the Six Essential Elements keyword sets for reference. - Negative keywords: not evident in the visible site text (no explicit values-neutral or relativist framing observed in the About page text). The lexicon lists possible negatives (e.g., secular humanism, relativism), but they do not appear in the public content provided for this school.

Why this rating - The presence of a Christian worldview and stated theology-related elements strongly anchors this category in the classical tradition's religious/metaphysical footing, even if liturgical practices are not explicitly described on the site. The school's language around "truth of Scripture" and a clear theological frame supports a CLASSICAL orientation in Foundations, but the absence of explicit liturgical practices or more explicit transcendental realism signals not full, unambiguous signaling across all sub-facets. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Citations - About page content and faith-based framing: - Classical/Christian lexicon alignment (positives): see Six Essential Elements lexicon via turn1file1 and related keyword references in turn2file0.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies its mission as forming students in a Christian classical tradition, aiming to shape culture through truth of Scripture and love of the Lord, with emphasis on partnership with parents. This highlights formation and a teleology oriented toward virtue and wisdom rather than only career-readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (from the site): formation, virtue, wisdom (implied by formation of character), liberal education/classical mission, telos, truth/goodness/beauty (via Scripture truth and Christian worldview). The Six Essential Elements lexicon explicitly lists formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as central positives; the school's language aligns with these aims. - Negative keywords present: none of the typical "workforce-ready" or highly utilitarian terms appear in the public Mission/About language. This supports a classical purpose orientation rather than a job-prep stance. The lexicon's negatives (e.g., career readiness, skills-only) are not prominent in the school's public materials.

Why this rating - The school states it seeks formation through a classical framework with a Christian teleology, aligning with the classical aim of education as formation of character and wisdom rather than mere information. The public content emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and truth as real and knowable ideals, consistent with the CLASSICAL designation for this category.

Citations - About page and mission framing: - Positive keyword sets (formation, virtue, truth, classical mission) via Six Essential Elements lexicon and related guidance: turn1file1, turn2file0.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The About page states: "Paideia provides a classically based curriculum focused on language, mathematics, rhetoric, history, art, and literature." This signals a classical curriculum architecture and liberal-arts orientation, though it does not enumerate the full seven liberal arts (Trivium/ Quadrivium) or explicit Great Books engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: language, mathematics, rhetoric, history, art, literature (curricular domains aligned with classical liberal arts). The lexicon's Positive Keywords section includes elements like grammar, logic, rhetoric, arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy, as well as Great Books and Great Conversation motifs; the school mentions some of these domains (particularly language, mathematics, rhetoric, history). - Negative keywords present: not evidenced in the publicly available curriculum language. However, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation (key classical signals) are not stated on the site; nor is there a clear listing of Trivium/Quadrivium in the public materials. This absence is notable relative to a full classical curriculum claim. The Six Essential Elements lexicon flags lack of Great Books and Great Conversation as a negative signal.

Why this rating - The curriculum is described as classically based and includes core liberal-arts domains, which supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating. The absence of explicit Great Books engagement, explicit Trivium/ Quadrivium integration, or explicit emphasis on Great Conversation reduces it from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Citations - About page curriculum language: - Positive keywords alignment and Great Books/Great Conversation caveats in the Six Essentials lexicon (turn1file1) and lexicon reference (turn2file0).

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe a “classical method” in a generic sense but do not publicly document specific classical pedagogies (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization/recitation, or structured pause for contemplation). The site text does not enumerate a pedagogy that matches the full classical pedagogy catalog (e.g., Socratic dialogue, recitation, or liturgical/chant-based memory work).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: none from the site’s public text that directly align to the Pedagogy sub-criteria (e.g., Socratic seminar, scholé, memorization, liturgical learning, etc.). The Classical Pedagogy lexicon highlights terms like Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, and rest/chanting; these are not publicly evidenced in the school’s materials. - Negative keywords present: the absence of explicit classical pedagogy signals can be read as a lack of alignment with the Pedagogy criteria. The Six Essential Elements lexicon lists negative indicators such as exclusive project-based learning or modern, non-Socratic approaches; these do not appear as explicit signals in the school’s public materials.

Why this rating - The school is described in terms of classical identity and curriculum but public-facing materials do not document the explicit Pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, scholé-based rest, memorization/recitation) that the classical rubric expects. This aligns with a NOT CLASSICAL designation for Pedagogy.

Citations - Pedagogy absence in About text: - Pedagogy keyword framework (Socratic, scholé, chant, memorization) via Six Essentials lexicon: turn2file0, turn1file1.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials do not provide a portrait of faculty, living curriculum, or mentorship expectations. There is no explicit description of teachers as models of virtue or as the living curriculum in the publicly available About text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: none explicitly in the public-facing content. The Six Essential Elements lexicon identifies “Teachers as models of virtue,” “mentorship and collegiality,” and a living curriculum as strong signals; these are not evidenced in the school’s public materials. - Negative keywords present: not explicit in the available public text either; however, the absence of teacher portraits or faculty archetypes suggests the category cannot be rated Classical based on evidence. The lexicon notes absence of such signals as a negative or missing indicator.

Why this rating - Without explicit public statements about faculty as exemplars, mentors, or a living curriculum, the school does not meet the category’s classical faculty signals. This yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Faculty.

Citations - Faculty absence in About text: - Faculty keyword framework (positive/negative signals) via Six Essentials lexicon: turn1file1, turn2file0.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnering with parents to train students in the classical method rooted in a Christian worldview; the About page explicitly notes a partnership with parents and a Christian worldview, and the mission/covenant framing implies parental involvement as co-educators. This aligns with the traditional classical model of parent-school partnership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental primacy, parental formation, home-centered learning, family catechesis, classical parent training, parental involvement, and school as a community of learners. These terms map directly to Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon’s Parents & Community section. - Negative keywords present: none observed; the school’s public language promotes open engagement with parents rather than a consumer-only model. The lexicon includes potential negatives (e.g., consumer language) that do not appear in the public content.

Why this rating - The explicit emphasis on parental partnership, co-education, and ongoing parent engagement signals a CLASSICAL orientation for the Parents & Community category. The school's stated model aligns with the classical ideal of parents as co-educators in the enculturation process.

Citations - Partnership with parents language (About page): - Parents & Community keyword framework via Six Essentials lexicon: turn1file1, turn2file0.

Aggregate Assessment (Six Categories)

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale - While three categories show CLASSICAL alignment (Religious Foundations, School Purpose/-Goal, Parents & Community), two categories do not clearly evidence classical signals (Pedagogy and Faculty), and one category shows only partial alignment (Curriculum). The balance yields an overall classification of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reflecting a clear classical identity and goals, but with notable gaps in publicly evidenced pedagogy and faculty signals, and only partial explicit curriculum depth (e.g., Great Books/Great Conversation not publicly confirmed).

What Would Move the Needle (for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Pedagogy (Element 4)
 - Publicly articulate and publish the school's pedagogy in classical terms: include explicit mentions of Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation/chanting, and consistent use of Socratic seminars or Paideia-style seminars for appropriate grades. Provide examples from actual classes or sample lesson plans that showcase Socratic discussion and disciplined dialogue. This would move Pedagogy to CLASSICAL.
 - Include language about liberal arts pedagogy across grades (K–12) and a deliberate progression from grammar-stage memorization to dialectic/rhetoric in upper grades.
- Curriculum (Element 3)
 - Clarify and publicize engagement with Great Books and Great Conversation; detail specific works, primary sources, and text-reading expectations across grades.
 - Provide explicit Trivium/Quadrivium mapping (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music) and show how these disciplines are woven across the curriculum, along with experiential wonder elements tied to the Great Conversation.
- Faculty (Element 5)
 - Introduce faculty profiles that emphasize virtuous exemplars, mentoring, and the “living curriculum” concept. Publish a faculty handbook or a section on teacher formation aligned with classical practices (character formation, lifelong learning, and collaboration).
- Religious Foundations (Element 1)
 - If possible, articulate liturgical or communal practices more explicitly (e.g., chapel schedules, liturgical calendar integration, or communal worship elements) to strengthen the Liturgical/Communal Practices signal, while maintaining a Christian theological framing.
- Curriculum and Great Books alignment (Element 3)
 - Publish a clear, publicly accessible curriculum map that shows how Great Books, primary sources, and classical texts are integrated with Great Conversation ideas, to strengthen the overall CLASSICAL signal in Curriculum.

Citations - Foundational statements and evidence (About page text): - Classical elements and keyword framework (Six Essential Elements lexicon): turn1file1, turn2file0 - Additional context on the classical lexicon and Great Books signals (Six Essential Elements and Lexicon references): turn1file6, turn2file0

What Would Move the Needle

- Publish concrete, school-wide statements of pedagogy aligned with scholé, Socratic dialogue, memory work, and liturgical learning.
- Publish a detailed curriculum map that explicitly includes Great Books/Great Conversation and Trivium/Quadrivium alignment.
- Add faculty profiles and a living-curriculum narrative to demonstrate teacher virtue, mentorship, and collegiality.
- Expand liturgical/community practices documentation (chapel, liturgical calendar, music, and communal practices) to strengthen Religious Foundations signals.
- Create parent-focused programming (book studies, parent gatherings) and a formal “parents as co-educators” framework with clear expectations and opportunities.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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